



Photo: NRC/Karl Schombert

Yasser al Hibshi: "We were asleep at 2am when suddenly a bomb fell on our house. Three of my children were killed: my daughter Aisha, and my sons Ammar and Alaa al Deen. I had spent more than five years to build this house. My children were everything to me. They are all gone now."

YEMEN | Large-scale destruction and internal displacement

The end of 2016 recorded more than 19 months of conflict in Yemen, that left an estimated 19 million people in need of humanitarian and protection assistance. This included 10 million people who required immediate, life-saving assistance. The conflict caused a pervasive protection crisis, forced displacement, severe economic decline, and the collapse of basic services and institutions.

Despite efforts by humanitarian organisations to provide much needed assistance, by the end of the year an estimated 14 million people were food insecure. Over 14 million people required assistance to ensure access to safe drinking water and sanitation. About 2 million school-age children were out of school.

Food security and livelihoods

NRC's food security interventions in Yemen aimed to address emergency food needs of displaced people, returnees and host communities. The interventions also contributed to reduced malnutrition among children and lactating mothers.

NRC supported most vulnerable groups to access food by providing unconditional cash transfers, engaging them in cash-for-work activities and conducting food distributions.

Emergency cash grants enabled vulnerable households to purchase food and gave them an opportunity to meet other basic needs.



Photo: NRC/Nuha Mohammed

"I am extremely surprised that I am still alive. I thought I was going to die. Too many people have died," 12-year-old Fatima told NRC. She survived airstrikes that hit Mount Noqum, on the outskirts of the Yemeni capital Sana'a. The bombardments brought down apartment homes, and resulted in deaths and massive destruction.

NRC supported vulnerable households to access shelter. Families received household items including mattresses, sleeping mats, blankets, mosquito nets, water buckets and kitchen utensils. This helped over 26,000 people, improving living conditions and enhancing protection.

Families supported with cash grants were able to buy food in the local market, boosting the local economy. Those supported through food distributions improved their daily food consumption from one to two or three meals per day. Families that received vouchers reported improvement in the variety of food types consumed.

Water, sanitation and hygiene

NRC provided clean water through trucking services, and distributed hygiene and dignity kits to displaced communities in Amran, Hudeidah, Lahj and Taiz governorates. These initiatives were carried out at the community level, and benefitted from collaboration with community volunteers. Hygiene promotion messages helped to minimise the spread of water-borne infections.

Through funding from various donors including NMFA, SIDA, UN-OCHA, ECHO, DFID and DFTAD, NRC helped to rehabilitate water schemes and provide water-pumping equipment in Amran, Hajjah, Hodeidah and Lahj. We worked with local authorities, community leaders and project beneficiaries to strengthen ownership and maintenance of rehabilitated facilities.

Education

In 2016, with funding from NMFA, NRC implemented an education project in the Lahj Governorate targeting out-of-school children from internally displaced and host communities. The project constructed new classrooms, rehabilitated damaged classrooms and

gave materials to students in four schools.

The project benefited 3,400 schoolchildren. The new classrooms resulted in a 15 per cent increase in learning space and an 18 per cent increase in student enrolment.

In addition, NRC conducted a campaign named “back to school” in the Lahj Governorate, in collaboration with the Ministry of Education. The campaign made people aware about the importance of enrolling in school, with a particular focus on girls who are more prone to dropping out.

Shelter

The conflict increased shelter needs significantly. Displaced families were living in dire conditions in open spaces, public buildings, or seeking shelter from relatives in crowded, unhygienic spaces. Despite the increase in needs, the shelter sector remained critically underfunded at 7 per cent of the humanitarian implementation plan requirement.

NRC supported vulnerable households to access shelter. Where appropriate, households received cash grants to rent alternative accommodation and reduce their vulnerability. The rental subsidies to displaced people living with relatives or friends in urban centres helped ease the pressure on host families.

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Not enough food for Amani

Amani (3 months old) suffers from malnutrition. She is five months old and only weighs 2 kilogrammes. Her 20-year-old mother Fatima is concerned that she will not find enough food for her little baby once they are out of the hospital.

“Our neighbours gave us money to take Amani to the hospital,” Fatima says. “My husband could not join me because he stayed to take care of our other child”



Photo: